

Too Hard Core to HANDLE

Sometimes it's hard to believe in science. Here's some new research that will send your eyebrows up.



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IQ Up in Smoke

Jean Paul Sartre, the French novelist and philosopher, died of immoderate smoking and drinking. But the father of existentialism never lost his marbles. New research led by Israeli scientists now claims that intelligence decreases the more one smokes. IQ scores among young men fall between 84 and 116, but those who smoked more than a pack of cigarettes a day averaged just 90 between them. Believe it or not.

Vanity at 60

Rich married men approaching retirement have the highest self-esteem, reports the American Psychological Association. Confidence is apparently lowest among young adults, but increases with age until it peaks around age 60. Retirement and

failing health cause a decline.

Women are generally less confident, catching up only in their 80s or 90s.



The Fryway to Health



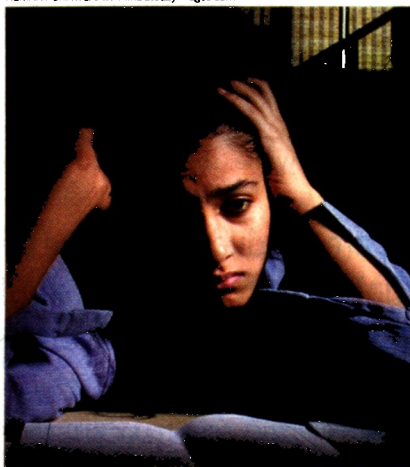
Paranthas, samosas, bacon, eggs... spread everything fried on the breakfast platter. Fried breakfast makes the healthiest start to the day, according to new research. Scientists believe that breakfast programmes the metabolism for the rest of the day. And a fatty meal will help the body break down fat later on. Carbohydrate-rich foods, in contrast, appear mainly to prepare the body to break down only carbohydrates, the *International Journal of Obesity* reports. If you really want to be able to efficiently respond to mixed meals across a day, a meal in higher fat content in the morning is a good thing, add scientists. So go ahead guilt-free and have the most sinful breakfast you can think of every morning.

WINE AND WOMEN

Mr Muthalik won't like this one. But new research from London School of Economics says the more educated women are, the more likely they are to drink alcohol. Possible explanation? Educated women have better careers, tend to have children later, postpone the responsibilities of parenthood, have more active social lives and work in male-dominated workplaces with a drinking culture. All that intelligence is counter-intuitive to health, though: it makes women sitting ducks for health problems—from cancer and heart disease to mental issues.



HEMANT CHAWLA/www.indiatodayimages.com



Be A Worry Bug

Sometimes worry can be a good thing. It can get you to plan better, focus better and negate the ill-effects of depression—reports a study in *Cognitive, Affective & Behavioural Neuroscience*. But there are two types of anxiety that produce different patterns in the brain. Watch out for anxious arousal characterised by fear and panic, which is bad for your mental health. It's plain worrying that counters the effects of depression in the brain. So go ahead and worry as much as you want to beat the blues.

■ Compiled by Damayanti Datta